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The Hindu Editorial Vocabulary

Vocabulary:

1.Undermining

Meaning: The act of weakening or damaging something, especially authority or confidence.

2. Penchant

Meaning: A strong or habitual liking for something or tendency to do something.

3. Debarment

Meaning: The act of officially preventing someone from doing something.

4. Pragmatic

Meaning: Dealing with things sensibly and realistically in a way that is based on practical considerations.

5. Fatigue

Meaning: Extreme tiredness resulting from mental or physical exertion or illness.

6. Cumbersome

Meaning: Large or heavy and therefore difficult to carry or use; unwieldy.

7. Obliterate

Meaning: To destroy completely; to wipe out.

8. Stifling

Meaning: Making it difficult to breathe or causing a feeling of suffocation; suppressing.

9. Accentuate

Meaning: To make something more noticeable or prominent.

10. Overwhelming

Meaning: Very intense; too great to deal with.

Phrasal Expressions:

1. Winnow down:

Meaning: To narrow down or reduce something, often by eliminating unnecessary elements.

2. Nail down:

Meaning: To secure a specific decision, agreement, or understanding; to finalize something.

3. Sort through:

Meaning: To examine a collection of items or information to organize or find something specific.

4. Jack up:

Meaning: To increase something significantly, often abruptly, such as prices or rates.

Idioms and Phrases:

1. On one's toes
Meaning: ready for any eventuality; alert

2. Green with envy
Meaning: to be very jealous, envious

3. Lose one's touch
Meaning: to stop communicating with someone

4. Once and for all
Meaning: now and for the last time

5. Easy as ABC
Meaning: extremely easy or straightforward

Articles (Reading & Skimming)

Article for Reading:
India's data protection rules need some fine-tuning

On January 3, 2025, the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) released the much-anticipated Draft Digital Personal Data Protection (DPDP) Rules — a key moment in India's journey to regulate digital personal data. This step follows the passage of the DPDP Act, 2023, bringing India closer to operationalising its framework for safeguarding personal data. The draft rules represent a departure from the earlier and controversial Personal Data Protection Bill, which many deemed was overly restrictive and even hostile to industry interests. The Bill underwent extensive framing, reframing and consultations over nearly a decade, only to be rescinded when committees and government stakeholders wisely decided it was untenable. In contrast, the positive response to the DPDP Act and its accompanying rules, reflected in conversations with businesses and in media coverage, stems from the less prescriptive, principles-based approach of the draft rules. Unlike the earlier rush to regulate under the so-called "Brussels Effect", where global digital rulemaking mirrored the European Union (EU)'s interventionist regulatory ethos, India has taken a more pragmatic stance. The EU's General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR), once hailed as a gold standard by privacy experts, now faces criticism for unintended consequences — favouring well-resourced corporations, stifling smaller enterprises, and failing to significantly enhance public trust in the Internet. India's measured approach thus far offers a refreshing alternative to Europe's interventionist policies. One of the draft rules' standout features is their principles-based framework for notice and consent. While the GDPR has cumbersome requirements, such as notifying users of indirect data acquisition, cross-border data transfers, and automated decision-making processes, India's rules emphasise simplicity and clarity. This helps reduce "consent fatigue", a significant issue in Europe, where users are inundated with unnecessary details, such as

the location of data processing — information of little practical use. In 2023, the European Commission introduced the Cookie Pledge Initiative to address growing frustration over incessant consent pop-ups. However, such course correction would have been unnecessary had the EU taken a less invasive approach to regulating user interfaces and consent mechanisms. The very existence of this pledge highlights the burdens created by prescriptive regulation. India’s DPDP Rules sidestep these pitfalls by focusing on outcomes rather than processes, empowering users without drowning businesses and consumers in unnecessary complexities. The rules avoid dictating how entities should enable users to exercise their rights to correction, erasure, nomination, withdrawal of consent and to seek information from entities. They require only the publication of relevant information on apps and websites. In contrast, the GDPR is prescriptive about how similar information should be presented, including instances where entities may need to provide this information orally to users. Summary The passage discusses the release of India's Draft Digital Personal Data Protection (DPDP) Rules by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology on January 3, 2025. These rules represent a significant step in India’s data regulation journey, marking a shift from the controversial Personal Data Protection Bill and adopting a principles-based approach rather than the prescriptive regulatory ethos seen in the EU’s GDPR. The DPDP rules focus on simplicity, clarity, and user empowerment while avoiding excessive regulatory burdens like those associated with the GDPR, which has faced criticism for its unintended consequences, such as disadvantaging smaller enterprises and causing "consent fatigue." India’s approach emphasizes outcomes over processes, sidestepping complexities and focusing on user-friendly regulations, contrasting with the EU’s interventionist policies. The tone is analytical and optimistic, highlighting the pragmatic and balanced nature of India’s regulatory framework compared to the EU’s more prescriptive approach. It reflects a sense of approval for India’s less invasive and more adaptable principles-based model while critiquing the shortcomings of the GDPR.

Article for Skimming:

Centralising control: on the Draft UGC Regulations, 2025

In a federal setup, attempts at undermining any stakeholder in the subject matter of education, which is in the Concurrent List, will prove disruptive. The Draft UGC (Minimum Qualifications for Appointment and Promotion of Teachers and Academic Staff in Universities and Colleges and Measures for the Maintenance of Standards in Higher Education) Regulations, 2025, seeks to do precisely this. Demonstrating the Centre's penchant for facilitating control over institutions through gubernatorial proxies, it proposes to divest State governments of their role in the selection process for Vice Chancellor (VC) of universities. All powers are sought to be vested in the Chancellor — i.e., the Governor in most State universities — by taking away the function of constituting the search-cum-selection committee from the higher education departments. Such a committee would comprise a nominee each of the Chancellor; UGC Chairman; and of the respective university syndicate/senate. The Chancellor would appoint the VC out of three to five names recommended by the committee. Any violations, the draft warns, could attract debarment from participating in UGC schemes and denial of funding under the UGC Act. This comes against the backdrop of conflicts between State governments and Raj Bhavans on appointing VCs, which have deprived several universities, particularly in Tamil Nadu, of leadership. Naturally, opposition has come from several States, including Tamil Nadu, which passed a House resolution urging the Centre to immediately withdraw the draft. Tamil Nadu Chief Minister M.K. Stalin has argued that the draft is not only against the basic federal principles enshrined in the Constitution but also poses a threat to the higher education system. Kerala Chief Minister Pinarayi Vijayan, the AIADMK and the CPI-M have endorsed this stance. A proposal to make

non-academics eligible for the VC's job has also drawn criticism. The draft says such non-academics must have served for at least 10 years at a senior level in industry, public administration, public policy and/or public sector undertakings, with a proven track record of significant academic or scholarly contributions. Mr. Vijayan fears this could be used to appoint Sangh Parivar loyalists. However, universities have benefited from the scholarship of non-academics such as former President K.R. Narayanan and scientist Y. Nayudamma; appointing academics does not guarantee visionary leadership. The proposal to extend the VC's tenure from the typical three to five years is welcome. The UGC would do well to remove anti-federal clauses from the draft regulations and allay apprehensions on other provisions. In the long run, it should aim for reforms to obliterate any governmental role in university administration, except maybe, for funding, and elevate them into truly autonomous institutions that nurture excellence.

Descriptive Writing (Letter & Essay)

- Write an essay of 200 words about the effects of screen time on child development

Excessive screen time has significant effects on child development, impacting physical, cognitive, and social aspects. Physically, prolonged screen exposure often leads to a sedentary lifestyle, which can increase the risk of obesity and other health issues. Children who spend hours in front of screens may also experience eye strain and disrupted sleep patterns due to blue light exposure, which can impair their overall health and growth. Cognitively, excessive screen time may hinder critical development stages. Young children need hands-on, interactive experiences to build problem-solving skills and foster creativity, yet passive consumption of screen content can delay these processes. Studies have shown that children with high screen exposure often perform lower in areas like language, memory, and attention compared to peers with limited screen time. Socially, screen dependency can impede essential interpersonal skills. Children who spend more time on screens may have less time for face-to-face interactions, limiting opportunities to develop empathy, communication, and conflict-resolution skills. Additionally, excessive screen time can contribute to behavioral issues, as children may become more irritable or withdrawn without their devices. To promote healthy development, a balanced approach that includes adequate screen-free time is crucial, allowing children to explore the world actively and build meaningful relationships.

- **Write a letter to your friend describing a place that you have visited recently**

[Your Address]
[City, Zip Code]
[Date]
Dear [Friend's Name],
I hope you're well! I recently visited [Place Name], and I thought of you the whole time. The place was beautiful – surrounded by lush greenery and peaceful views. I visited [specific attraction or landmark] and was amazed by the breathtaking scenery. The local food, especially [mention a dish], was delicious, and the people were incredibly warm and welcoming.
I know you'd love the vibe here; maybe we can plan a trip together someday!
Take care,
[Your Name]

Perfection Vocab

Adherence: The act of sticking to or being faithful to something, such as rules or principles.
Polarity: The state of having two opposite tendencies or aspects.
Coherence: The quality of being logical and consistent.
Solidarity: Unity or agreement of feeling or action among individuals with a common interest.
Rectification: The act of correcting or making something right.
Squalid: Extremely dirty and unpleasant, especially due to poverty or neglect.
Submissive: Ready to conform to the authority or will of others; meek or obedient.
Prestigious: Having high status or respect due to achievements or qualities.
Banal: Lacking originality, freshness, or novelty; boring.
Trivial: Of little importance or value.
Momentum: The force or speed of movement or progress.
Alleviation: The act of making something less severe or intense.
Entitlement: The belief that one is inherently deserving of privileges or special treatment.
Assimilation: The process of absorbing and integrating into a culture or system.
Dissonance: A lack of harmony or agreement between people, ideas, or things.
Exacerbating: Making a problem, bad situation, or negative

feeling worse.
Ameliorating: Making something better or improving a situation.
Undermining: Weakening or damaging something, especially authority or confidence.
Vindicating: Clearing someone of blame or suspicion.
Reckoning: The act of calculating or estimating something; judgment or assessment.
Forbearance: Patient self-control; restraint and tolerance.
Customary: According to the usual practices or traditions of a group or place.
Insurmountable: Impossible to overcome or deal with.
Solemn: Formal, serious, or dignified in manner or character.
Impeached: Formally charged with misconduct in office.
Convene: To bring people together for a meeting or assembly.
Refrain: To stop oneself from doing something.
Pervert: To distort or corrupt the original meaning or intent of something.
Escalate: To increase or intensify rapidly.
Unitive: Serving to unite or bring together.
Unprecedented: Never done or known before.
Virtuous: Having or showing high moral standards.
Enlightened: Having a rational, well-informed, and progressive outlook.
Endorsed: Publicly or officially supported or approved.
Dissipate: To disappear or cause to disappear; to waste.
Curtail: To reduce or limit something.
Exacerbate: To make a situation or condition worse.
Advocate: To support or argue in favor of something.

Forged: Created or shaped, often with effort or skill.
Vaunted: Highly praised or boasted about.
Capitalized: Taken advantage of or used for gain.
Slated: Scheduled or planned for a particular purpose.
Inflicted: Caused harm, damage, or suffering.
Engendered: Caused or gave rise to something.
Dilatory: Slow to act or intended to cause delay.
Astute: Having sharp judgment and the ability to assess situations effectively.
Substantial: Of considerable importance, size, or worth.
Morphed: Changed or transformed.
Precarious: Not securely held or in position; dangerously uncertain.
Feeble: Lacking physical strength or effectiveness.
Salient: Most noticeable or important.
Dispensation: Exemption from a rule or usual requirement; the act of distributing something.
Vindictive: Having or showing a desire for revenge.
Offset: To balance or counteract something.
Attribute: To regard something as being caused by someone or something.
Rankle: To cause irritation or resentment.
Replicate: To make an exact copy of something.
Stymie: To hinder or prevent the progress of something.
Subversion: The act of undermining or overthrowing an established system.
Concurrence: Agreement or simultaneous occurrence.
Indictment: A formal charge or accusation of a serious crime.
Injunction: A legal order that prevents someone from

performing an act.
Discourse: Written or spoken communication or debate.
Avert: To prevent or turn away.
Muddle: To mix up or confuse.
Stun: To shock or daze someone.
Overhaul: To take apart and examine for repair or improvement.
Revolutionize: To bring about a radical change.
Proliferate: To increase rapidly in number.
Bridge: To connect or reduce the gap between two things.
Retaliate: To take revenge or respond in kind.
Persist: To continue firmly despite difficulties.
Fluctuate: To rise and fall irregularly in amount or level.

READING COMPREHENSION

The increasing penetration of technology in every aspect of life has significantly transformed the way businesses operate. Automation and artificial intelligence (AI) are now key components driving efficiency and innovation. These technologies enable companies to analyze vast amounts of data, streamline processes, and improve customer experiences. However, this rapid technological advancement also raises concerns about job displacement. While automation can take over repetitive tasks, it necessitates reskilling of workers to perform more complex roles.

Moreover, businesses that leverage technology responsibly tend to build better trust with stakeholders. Ethical considerations, such as data privacy and fair usage, play a crucial role in maintaining consumer confidence. In contrast, misuse of technology can lead to public outcry and regulatory actions. As technology continues to evolve, businesses must strike a balance between innovation and ethics to sustain long-term growth.

1. According to the passage, what is one major benefit of automation for businesses?

A. Increased unemployment rates
B. Enhanced data analysis and streamlined processes
C. Reduced importance of customer experiences
D. Greater dependency on manual labor

2. What challenge does automation pose, as mentioned in the passage?

A. Decreased trust among stakeholders
B. Difficulty in analyzing data
C. Job displacement requiring reskilling of workers
D. Reduced ethical considerations in businesses

3. How can businesses build trust with stakeholders, according to the passage?

A. By minimizing innovation and focusing on traditional methods
B. By ensuring responsible use of technology and prioritizing ethics
C. By disregarding concerns about data privacy
D. By solely focusing on profit maximization

4. What could be a consequence of technology misuse by businesses?

A. Increased stakeholder confidence
B. Public approval and regulatory support

C. Public backlash and possible regulatory actions

D. Enhanced innovation without any ethical concerns

5. What is the primary theme of the passage?

A. The decline of traditional business practices

B. The role of technology in transforming business and its challenges

C. The irrelevance of ethics in technological advancement

D. The elimination of manual labor in businesses

Solutions and Explanations

1. Answer: B. Enhanced data analysis and streamlined processes

Explanation: The passage highlights that automation and AI help businesses analyze vast amounts of data and streamline processes, improving efficiency and innovation.

2. Answer: C. Job displacement requiring reskilling of workers

Explanation: The passage mentions that while automation handles repetitive tasks, it requires workers to be reskilled for more complex roles, presenting a challenge.

3. Answer: B. By ensuring responsible use of technology and prioritizing ethics

Explanation: Responsible use of technology and addressing ethical considerations, such as data privacy, are mentioned as key factors for building stakeholder trust.

4. Answer: C. Public backlash and possible regulatory actions

Explanation: The passage warns that misuse of technology can lead to public outcry and regulatory interventions, emphasizing the importance of ethical practices.

5. Answer: B. The role of technology in transforming business and its challenges

Explanation: The passage discusses how technology is transforming businesses, its benefits like efficiency and innovation, and challenges such as job displacement and ethical concerns, making this the central theme.

Perfection(With Annotation) Pdf

CLOZE TESTS

- Vocabulary
- Part of Speech
- Tone

Strategy L Skim — what ?? < +ve / -ve

Question { Vocab, P of S, Tone

Most frequently used

A recent study on urbanization reveals a significant shift in the dynamics of global cities, highlighting a growing __(A)__ between the wealthy elite and the impoverished masses. The cities are increasingly dominated by opulent structures and the high-end consumer culture, while the lower-income neighborhoods face _____(B)____ living conditions. This growing ___(C)____ threatens the social fabric of urban centers. In the face of rapid development, the challenge for city planners lies in___(D)___ the needs of diverse communities, ensuring equal access to resources for all.

Skim - 30 sec

↑↑ ↓↓ gap

Inequality

This requires addressing not just economic concerns but also __(E)__ barriers such as education and healthcare.

A recent study on urbanization reveals a significant shift in the dynamics of global cities, highlighting a growing __(A)__ between the wealthy elite and the impoverished masses.

Question 1:

Which of the following best fits in **Option A?**

(a) adherence
(b) polarity
(c) coherence
(d) solidarity
(e) rectification

The cities are increasingly dominated by opulent structures and the high-end consumer culture, while the lower-income neighborhoods face _____(B)_____ living conditions.

(a) squalid
(b) submissive
(c) prestigious
(d) banal
(e) trivial

Question 2: Which of the following best fits in **Option B?**

This growing ____(C)____ threatens the social fabric of urban centers.

Question 3: Which of the following best fits in **Option C?**

(a) momentum
(b) alleviation
(c) entitlement
(d) assimilation
(e) dissonance

alleviate, ameliorate, allay, assuage, appease, pacify, placate, palliate, mollify, mitigate, propitiate, lull, tranquilize, soothe, calm, relax, lessen, ease, reduce, diminish, quell, curb, curtail, abate

In the face of rapid development, the challenge for city planners lies in ____(D)____ the needs of diverse communities, ensuring equal access to resources for all.

Question 4: Which of the following best fits in **Option D?**

(a) exacerbating
(b) ameliorating
(c) undermining
(d) vindicating
(e) reckoning

aggravating, intensifying, worsening, identifying, calculating, estimating

to + V^1 + ing

+ V^1 + ing

This requires addressing not just economic concerns but also _____(E)_____ barriers such as education and healthcare.

(a) forbearance
(b) customary
(c) insurmountable
(d) solemn
(e) impeached

Question 5: Which of the following best fits in **Option E?**

The economic outlook for the coming years remains uncertain, with inflationary pressures continuing to __(A)___ . Central banks around the world have been grappling with the dilemma of how best to handle the __(B)___ surge in prices, particularly in energy and food sectors. Analysts are predicting that the tightening of monetary policy will only __(C)____ the economic slowdown, potentially leading to higher unemployment rates. On the other hand, the increasing costs of living have ___(D)____ a significant burden on the middle class, exacerbating social inequalities.

Amidst this turmoil, some economists argue that the key to recovery lies in __(E)___ investments in green technologies, which they believe will drive growth while also addressing climate change.

The economic outlook for the coming years remains uncertain, with inflationary pressures continuing to __(A)__ .

(a) temper – moderate
(b) convene – call for meeting
(c) refrain – avoid
(d) pervert – spoil/mar
(e) escalate – increase

Question 6:

Which of the following best fits in **Option A?**

increase, rise, snowball, ascend, enhance, augment, amplify, surge, soar, spike, mushroom, hike, spiral, skyrocket, proliferate, ramp up, jack up, thrive (grow), balloon, spur, burgeon, aggravate, exacerbate, intensify, boost, escalate

Central banks around the world have been grappling with the dilemma (confusion) of how best to handle the __(B)__ (Adj) surge (increase) in prices, particularly in energy and food sectors.

struggling

Question 7:

Which of the following best fits in **Option B?**

Vice and Virtue

(a) punitive – intended as a punishment
(b) unprecedented – something that has never happened before
(c) virtuous – ethical
(d) enlightened
(e) endorsed – supported

Enlightened

Analysts are predicting that the tightening of monetary policy will only ___(C)___ the economic slowdown, potentially leading to higher unemployment rates.

(a) dissipate
(b) curtail
(c) exacerbate
(d) advocate
(e) forged

Question 8:

Which of the following best fits in **Option C?**

On the other hand, the increasing costs of living have ___(D)___ a significant burden on the middle class, exacerbating social inequalities.

(a) vaunted
(b) capitalised
(c) slated
(d) inflicted
(e) engendered

Question 9:

Which of the following best fits in **Option D?**

Amidst this turmoil, some economists argue that the key to recovery lies in ___(E)___ investments in green technologies, which they believe will drive growth while also addressing climate change.

(a) dilatory
(b) astute
(c) substantial
(d) morphed
(e) precarious

Question 10:

Which of the following best fits in **Option E?**

Set-3

Directions(11-15): The passage given below contains some blanks wherein the words have been removed. Find the word from the given options that is suitable for each blank and mark that as your answer.

The debate surrounding the ethical implications of artificial intelligence is becoming **__(A)___** as new developments emerge. One of the most contentious issues is whether AI systems will ever be able to **__(B)___** human emotions effectively. Critics argue that the pursuit of this capability could lead to a **__(C)___** of moral and ethical considerations, potentially rendering human judgment obsolete. On the other hand, proponents assert that such technological advancements could **__(D)___** society, particularly in areas such as healthcare and education. However,

The debate surrounding the ethical implications of artificial intelligence is becoming **__(A)___** as new developments emerge.

Adj

Question 11:

Which of the following best fits in **Option A?**

detrimental
dangerous
perilous
noxious
fatal

lethal
deadly
pernicious
hazardous
deleterious
inimical

catastrophic
cataclysmic

- Adj

(a) detriment — Noun (danger)
(b) feeble — weak
(c) salient — important
(d) dispensation — Noun (rule, distribution)
(e) vindictive — avengeful

One of the most contentious issues is whether AI systems will ever be able to __(B)__ human emotions effectively.

Question 12:

Which of the following best fits in **Option B?**

(a) offset
(b) attribute
(c) rankle
(d) replicate
(e) stymie

Question 13:

Critics argue that the pursuit of this capability could lead to a __(C)__ of moral and ethical considerations, potentially rendering human judgment obsolete.

Which of the following best fits in **Option C?**

(a) subversion
(b) concurrence
(c) indictment
(d) injunction
(e) discourse

On the other hand, proponents assert that such technological advancements could __(D)__ society, particularly in areas such as healthcare and education.

Question 14:

Which of the following best fits in **Option D?**

(a) avert
(b) muddle
(c) stun
(d) overhaul
(e) revolutionise

However, the debate will ultimately __(E)__ as society grapples with the balance between innovation and ethical responsibility.

Question 15:

Which of the following best fits in **Option E?**

(a) proliferate
(b) bridge
(c) retaliate
(d) persist
(e) fluctuate